Cedar Valley Family Center AI use policy

Draft for board review · Effective when the board approves it · Owner: Not yet named (see open questions) · Next review: In 12 months

Why we have this policy. We want AI to take paperwork off your plate. We also want to protect the people we serve and keep errors from going out under our name.

Who it covers. All staff, volunteers, contractors and board members.

TOOLS WE USE

- **Microsoft Copilot (pilot):** Pilot licenses only (development team and operations manager); no protected information.
- **No other AI tools:** No other AI tool is approved yet.
- **New tools, add-ons and AI features.** Luis approves any new tool, plugin, agent or AI feature in software we own, checking what data it sees. If it touches client data, Grace, our privacy officer, also approves.
- **Accounts.** Use your work account, and turn off any setting that lets the vendor train on what you type.

WHAT YOU CAN USE AI FOR

- Draft appeals in Copilot (pilot users).
- Draft thank-you letters in Copilot (pilot users).
- Summarize grant guidelines in Copilot (pilot users).

NEEDS APPROVAL FIRST

- New tool, plugin, agent or AI feature — *Luis (operations manager)*
- Any new tool that touches client data — *Luis and Grace (privacy officer)*

OFF LIMITS

- **Never put this into an AI tool** unless the tool is approved for it above: Case files: family names, addresses, income, immigration status, children's names, domestic violence, mental health and substance use notes (county contract). Donor names, giving history, major-gift notes. Student names, test scores, immigration status. Tutoring kids' names, grades, attendance (district agreement). Staff HR files. Passwords and logins.
- Browser plugins that read your email.
- Passing off AI-made images as real families or clients.
- AI writing public statements about the news. A person writes them.

CHECK EVERYTHING BEFORE IT GOES OUT

- A person checks everything AI helps write: facts, names, numbers, tone and bias.
- Check every number against its source, especially county and funder reports. You own what you send.

DECISIONS ABOUT PEOPLE

- AI never decides who gets emergency assistance funds. Caseworkers decide with their supervisor.
- AI does not decide who gets a job, services or a consequence. A person decides.

BEING OPEN ABOUT AI

- Label teaching materials made with AI.
- Answer funders honestly when they ask about AI, including in grant writing.
- Donor letters need no AI label if a person signed and meant them.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Tell Luis and Grace the same day. If client data is involved, Grace decides if it is a breach under the county contract.
- Reporting a mistake is expected. No one is punished for it.

WHO OWNS THIS POLICY

- The board approves this policy and any changes.
- Everyone gets an hour of training, not just an email.
- We review it every 12 months.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE BOARD

- Which tools do we pay for or allow: ChatGPT Team, Copilot for everyone, teachers' ChatGPT, or Canva AI images?
- Can AI help with case notes or county and funder reports, and who approves it?
- Can AI score the intake essay for class placement?
- Who owns this policy day to day?

Sample policy for an invented organization, drafted by Fulton Ring from a mock 30-minute call. Not legal advice; not reviewed by a real nonprofit.